



**College of Arts, Humanities and Social Sciences
Department of Foreign Languages**

Course Syllabus

Course Title

English for Academic Purposes

Course Code
0202112

Spring Semester, 2025/2026

Course Syllabus

Course Title	English for Academic Purposes										
Course Code	0202112										
Credit Hours	3				Contact Hours						
Course Category	☒	Univ. Req.		☐	Col. Req.		☐	Prog. Req.		Others	
Course Type	☒	Compulsory					☐	Elective			
Pre-requisite(s)	Meet UOS TOEFL or IELTS requirements										
Co-requisite(s)	None										
Semester	Spring				Year		2025-2026				
Instructor Name	Mutwakil Ismail Manzol										
Office Location	W3-212										
Tel. No.	06-5053329										
Email	mismail@sharjah.ac.ae										
Lecture Times											
Office Hours											

Course Description (as in the catalogue):

This course focuses on academic reading and writing skills, including extensive work in reading comprehension and retention. Students will practice identifying topics, determining the main idea of a text, recognizing the supporting details of a paragraph, recognizing authors' writing patterns, and understanding new vocabulary through context clues. Emphasis is given to the rhetorical structures of the cause-and-effect essay.

Course Learning Outcomes:

By the end of successful completion of this course, the student will be able to:

1. Formulate a topic, main idea sentence and major supporting details of a paragraph.
2. Identify the authors' writing patterns.
3. Identify context clues to identify meaning of new vocabulary based on such clues.
4. Write effective paragraphs.
5. Write a short essay using cause-effect organization.

Alignment of Course Student Learning Outcomes to Program Student Learning Outcomes

Program Learning Outcomes (PLOs)	Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs)
Identify the general principles and developments of humanities, social sciences, Islamic studies, IT, mathematics and natural sciences.	
Communicate effectively using direct and indirect tools in both Arabic and English.	Write effective paragraphs Write a short essay using cause-effect organization
Apply the basic concepts essential to a critical thinking and evaluation of argumentative discourse.	Formulate a topic, main idea sentence and major supporting details of a paragraph. Identify the authors' writing patterns. Identify context clues to identify meaning of new vocabulary based on such clues
Solve multiple-step problems through different (inductive, deductive and symbolic) modes of reasoning.	
Apply ethical standards in research and presentation of materials, including proper verbal citations.	Write effective paragraphs Write a short essay using cause-effect organization
Apply cognitive and affective skills necessary for life-long learning through engagement in behaviors conducive to individual well-being and development.	
Work independently and in collaboration with others in seeking and sharing knowledge.	
Discuss how ethics and social responsibility promote sustainable growth for present and future generations.	

Weekly Distribution of Course Topics/Contents

Week	Topic	Comments*	Course SLO
1.	- Introduction to the Course - Diagnostic reading comprehension	Course Syllabus	
2.	- Context Clues Part 1 and 2 - Task (1): Identify the meaning of unfamiliar words by analyzing the context; DO NOT check the dictionary! Use your critical and analytical thinking skills only. (4 points)	New Worlds & Supplementary Material Employability Skills: Critical thinking and analysis	3
3.	- Determine the Topic of Parts 1 and 2 - Task (2): Use the website to practice determining the topic of the paragraph. (2 points) - https://higher.mheducation.com/sites/0073123587/student_view0/chapter7/	New Worlds & Supplementary Material Employability Skills: Technology use, monitor & control	1
4.	- Locating the Stated Main Idea Parts 1 and 2 - Task (3): Read the passages carefully, identify the topic and then decide which sentence represents the main idea. (2 marks)	New Worlds & Supplementary Material Employability Skills: Critical thinking and analysis	1
5.	- Formulating the Implied Main Idea Parts 1 and 2 Task (4): Use the website for extra practice on formulating the implied main idea sentences (2 points)	New Worlds & Supplementary Material Employability Skills: Active Learning + technology use	1, 4
6.	- Identifying Major and Minor Supporting Details Parts 1 and 2	New Worlds & Supplementary Material	2
7.	Midterm exam revision		1,2,3,4,5
8.	Midterm Exam Recognize Authors Writing Patterns	New Worlds & Supplementary Material	1, 2, 3
9.	Introduce writing a Cause and Effect essay	Handouts	1, 2, 3
10.	Writing the Introduction	Handouts	4, 5
11.	Writing a Main Body Paragraph	Handouts	4, 5,
12.	Writing a Conclusion	Handouts	4, 5
13.	- Essay writing: Cause and effect essay - Task (5): Write a well-developed cause-effect essay. Use all the skills taught in class. Your causes/effects should be logical and convincing. (10)	Employability Skills: Persuasion and negotiation	4, 5
14.	Sentence Errors	Handouts	1,2,3,4,5
15.	Exam Review / Final Exams		
16.	Final Exam		

* In the comments, you can add the relevant chapter or notes, etc.

Information on out-of-class assignments with due dates for submission

Assignment/Activity	Due Date	Comments
Quizzes Quiz (1): Chapters 1+2 (Guessing meaning from context+ determining the topic of the paragraph) Quiz (2): Chapters 3+4	Weeks 4 & 7	10% 10%
Tasks	Week 2-13	10%
Essay	Week 12	10%

Students' Assessment:

Students are assessed as follows:

Assessment Tool(s)**	Date	Weight (%)
2 Quizzes	Week 4	20
5 Employability Skills	Week 2-13	10
Cause-Effect Essay	Week 12	10
Midterm	Week 8	20
Final	Week 16	40
Total		100

** You can modify / add other tools relevant to the course.

Course Outcome Assessment Plan:

Course LOs	Teaching/Learning Method(s)	Assessment Tool(s)	Performance Indicators	UoS Competencies
Formulate a topic, main idea sentence and major supporting details of a paragraph.	- Lecturing - Group discussions - Problem solving - Independent Learning	- Exams - Employability Skills (3-5)	The weighted average of outcome achievement is at least 70%	-Written Communication -Autonomy and resiliency - Digital literacy
Identify Authors' Writing Patterns	- Lecturing - Group discussions - Problem solving - Independent Learning	- Exams - Employability Skills (3-5)	The weighted average of outcome achievement is at least 70%	-Written Communication -Autonomy and resiliency - Digital literacy
Identify context clues to identify meaning of new vocabulary based on such clues.	- Lecturing - Group discussions - Problem solving - Independent Learning	- Exams - Employability Skills (3-5)	The weighted average of outcome achievement is at least 70%	-Written Communication -Autonomy and resiliency - Digital literacy
Write effective paragraphs.	- Lecturing - Group discussions - Problem solving - Independent Learning	Cause-Effect Essay	The weighted average of outcome achievement is at least 70%	-Written Communication -Autonomy and resiliency - Digital literacy -Teamwork / Collaboration

Course LOs	Teaching/Learning Method(s)	Assessment Tool(s)	Performance Indicators	UoS Competencies
Write a short essay using cause-effect organization	- Lecturing - Group discussions - Problem solving - Independent Learning	Cause-Effect Essay	The weighted average of outcome achievement is at least 70%	-Written Communication - Digital literacy -Teamwork /Collaboration

Scope and Nature of Assessment Tools

Quizzes/Exams:

All quizzes and exams target the reading and writing components of the course. They aim at measuring students' learning attainment and identifying areas for improvement in the course.

Employability Skills:

Throughout the semester, students are given weekly tasks which target specific employability skills that equip them in their future work field.

Writing Assignment:

At the end of the course, students are expected to write a well-developed cause-effect essay. This assignment will measure students' writing competency and their ability to elaborate ideas effectively. Students also learn how to organize their ideas to produce a well-coherent essay.

Teaching and Learning Resources:

Text Book(s):

Cortina, J. and Elder, J. (2014). New Worlds: An Introduction to College Reading, 5th ed. McGraw-Hill. Available on BB

Recommended Readings:

Self-access websites to support the course and encourage independent learning

Other Resources:

- <http://www.dartmouth.edu/~writing/materials/student/special/esl.shtml>
- <http://owl.english.purdue.edu/owl/resource/589/01/>
- <http://owl.english.purdue.edu/owl/resource/737/01/>

Attendance policy:

Undergraduate Courses – مساقات البكالوريوس			
Number of Sessions per Week عدد المحاضرات أسبوعياً	No. of Absences to constitute 10% عدد الغيابات لتشكيل 10%	No. of Absences to constitute 15% عدد الغيابات لتشكيل 15%	20% Absence (FA grade) 20% غياب (درجة حرمان)
1	2	3	4
2	3	5	7
3	5	7	10
4	6	9	13
5	8	11	16

Plagiarism/Cheating:

Students are expected to do their own work. You are allowed to work on assignments in teams only if specified by the instructor. In other words, students are encouraged to communicate about general principles of the course, but all assigned homework must be done on an individual basis. The instructor is available to provide any assistance that you may need. Cheating is considered a serious offense by the university. You should be aware of the severe penalty for cheating (refer to the student code of conduct published in the university catalogue).

Common grading rubrics

Cause-Effect Essay Rubric:

Cause/Effect Essay Evaluation Sheet

Name of student: _____

Introduction 1) Hook 2) Background information or definition of the topic 3) Thesis Statement c.1. States the purpose of the essay c.2. States the 2 parts of the essay c. 3. States the subject of the essay	/5
Body Paragraphs 1) Does each paragraph include a topic sentence that mentions the topic and control? 2) Are the supporting details all related to the topic sentence?	/10

3) Are there enough major and minor details? 4) Does each paragraph include a concluding sentence that restates the topic sentence and a comment on the topic? 5) Are you using enough signal words to shift from one idea to the other?	
Concluding Paragraph	/3
1) Does the concluding paragraph include one or two sentences that restate the thesis statement? 2) Does the concluding paragraph include your final comments/remarks/questions/concerns on the topic as well as a memorable ending?	
Mechanics	/5
1) Spelling 2) Punctuation 3) Capitalization	
Layout	/2
	/25